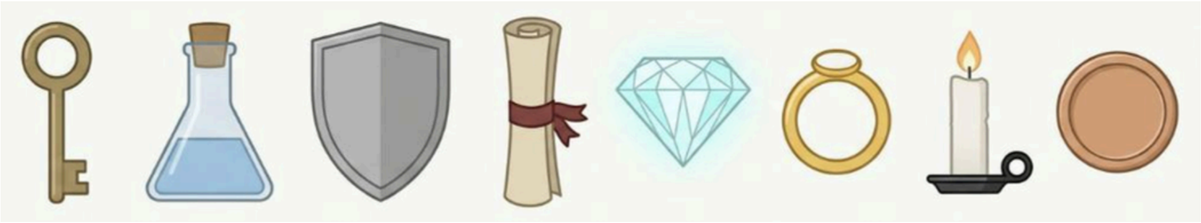
GAME DESIGN CONCEPTUALISATION

The Task:

USE THE PROPS SHOWN BELOW AND CONCEPTUALIZE AN INTERESTING GAME AROUND THEM. ARRANGE THE PROPS SUCH THAT THEY REPRESENT THE IN-GAME PROCEEDINGS (A LEVEL / CORE MECHANICS) EXPLAIN YOUR CONCEPT ON A MAXIMUM OF 5-SLIDES, INCLUDING CORE MECHANICS, PLAYER ACTIONS, AND OTHER GAME LOOPS.

- You can scale the objects/ make copies of existing elements/rotate them etc.
- Each icon type should represent a single type of in-game element.
- You cannot change colors/skew/edit existing elements or add new ones.
- Define what the chosen icons represent in the game.



Document:

HIGH CONCEPT

ONE LINE INTRODUCTION:

A 2D roguelite deckbuilder with adventure elements, tied together by a gripping mysterious narrative.

DESCRIPTION:

The game starts with an opening which shows the player receiving a phone call from the police during a stormy night. He gets to know his spouse's car is found abandoned in the middle of a road in a remote area. He immediately travels to the spot, despite the storm. Upon reaching, the player couldn't find the police. He did find his spouse's ring inside the card but nothing else. Even the mobile network in that area is terrible. The player realises that the mystery he is facing only seems to increase. The scene is eerily clean. There is nothing else inside the car, or out side. Except a clear trail that seems to enter straight inside the forest that surrounds him.
But somehow this unknown place feels oddly familiar to him, but he can't really figure out why?
Now the player has to find his spouse before its too late. He has to uncover the larger surrounding mystery and engage in combat whenever necessary.

SPECIFIED OBJECT'S USE CASE



Key: In the game these would be stages in the game that are there to provide the player with buffs while in a run. Such as upgrading a card, adding a card, gaining HP by resting, etc. The player will be provided with multiple options but only one of them would be free. The other ones can only be opened with a key. The player can earn keys as rewards, by finishing stages. But their drop frequency is randomised.



Fuel Jar: This is required to fuel the candel and keep it burning. It can be earned by defeating enemies. A massive amount of it can be used to perform attack or even defence.



Shield: This logo represents the amount of shield point the player has.



Scrolls: The player will recieve scrolls through out the game which will provide the player with quest activites, which the player can complete to earn rewards. It can also provide the player lore elements and puzzle hints.



Diamond: The premium currency of the game that can be used to buy keys. It can also be converted into Coins.



Ring: Lore wise this is the first object the player finds of his missing spouse from the scene. Mechanically this is the object which is making the player again and again when he dies.



Candle: The takes place in a dark stormy night, where the it works as the primery light and heat source for the player. It has a timer built in to it so the more the time passes the candle gets to a point of burning out completely. The player has to keep refilling it so that it stays burning. It can also be lit up after it has completely burned out. But during complete darkness the player can't see the figure, HP bar, or Status effect on the enemies. He can only detect them by their eyes. It can also be used in a combo to land a devastating attack with Burn status.



Coin: The common currency of the game that is earned through out the game by completing stages. It can be used to revive when the player dies in a run.

MECHANICS

CANDLE-FUEL SYSTEM (TIME & RISK/REWARD)

- **The Candle:** Acts as a primary light source and a constant timer. It slowly burns down as time passes.
- **Fuel Management:** Players must collect "Fuel Jars" by defeating enemies to keep the candle burning.
- **Darkness State:** If the candle burns out, the player enters a state of complete darkness. In this state, he cannot see enemy HP bars or status effects, and can only detect enemies by their glowing eyes.
- **Burn Combo:** While in darkness, the player can unleash a devastating attack that inflicts a "Burn" status on enemies, creating a high-risk, high-reward tactical choice.

DECKBUILDING & COMBAT DYNAMICS

- **Card Synergies:** Combat rewards players who creatively compound damage by using multiple unique card combinations.

RESOURCE & CURRENCY ECONOMY

- **Fuel Jars:** Combat resource used to fuel the candle or spent to perform powerful attacks and defences.
- **Shield Points:** Represents the player's current defence against incoming damage.
- **Keys:** Earned as randomised rewards. Used during rest stages to unlock additional options. One option is always free.
- **Coins:** Common currency earned by completing stages. Used to revive the player when they die during a run.
- **Diamonds:** Premium currency used to buy Keys or converted directly into Coins.

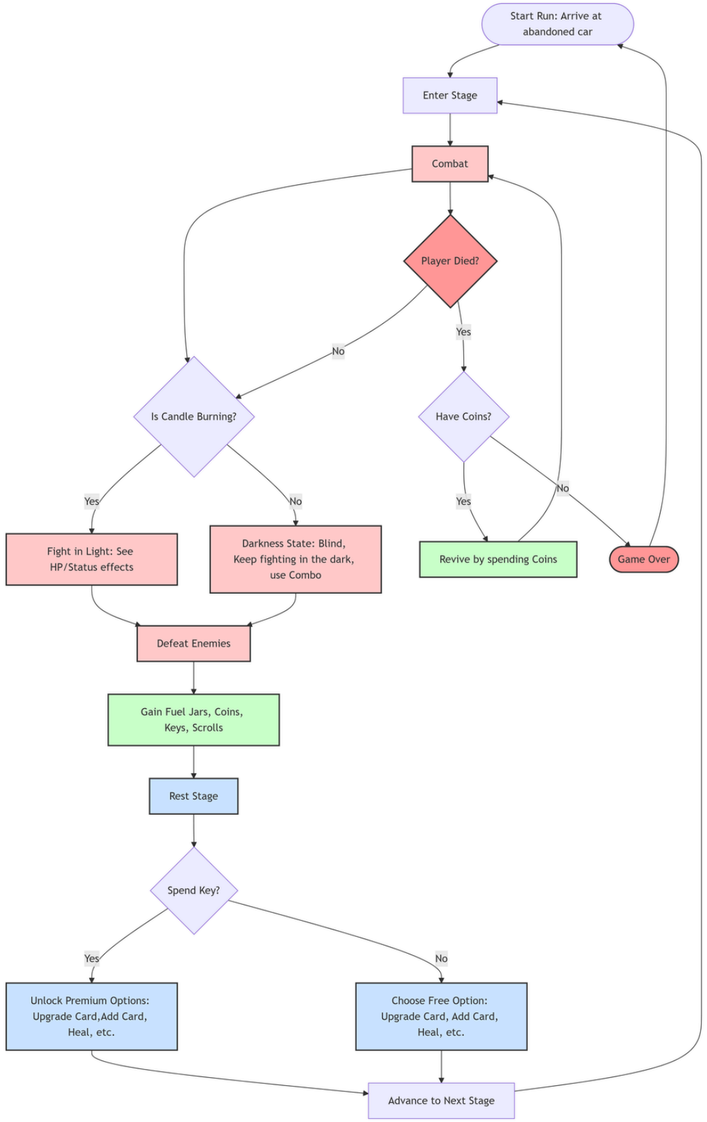
ROGUELITE PROGRESSION & NARRATIVE

- **The Ring (Revival):** Found in the abandoned car, the ring is the narrative catalyst and the mechanical anchor for the roguelite loop. It is what allows the player to keep coming back again and again when they die.
- **Scrolls:** Serve as the game's lore delivery system. They provide quest activities, puzzle hints, and narrative elements to uncover the larger mystery.

DYNAMICS

Due to the Candle-Fuel mechanic of the game, the player is encouraged to take down enemies as fast as possible. This game will reward the player who can creatively compound as much damage on the opponents as possible by using multiple unique card combinations.

GAMEPLAY LOOP



PLAYER ACTIONS

- **Deck Management:** Selecting, upgrading, and adding cards to their deck at rest stages.
- **Combat Execution:** Playing cards strategically to compound damage, managing Shield points, and deciding when to spend Fuel Jars for standard attacks versus saving them to refuel the Candle.
- **Exploration & Investigation:** Reading Scrolls to piece together the mystery.
- **Survival Decisions:** Choosing whether to play it safe by keeping the light on, or let the candle burn out deliberately to utilise the "Burn" attack.
- **Reviving:** Choosing to spend hard-earned Coins to continue a run after death.
- **Resource Routing:** Choosing between spending Keys on premium rest-stage upgrades or saving Diamonds to convert into Coins/Keys.

GAME REFERENCES

